

(it was at No. 11 last year). Interestingly, even as the government left no stone unturned to pitch the LIC story to both institutional and retail investors, market participants do not appear very gung-ho on the company. "LIC has brought insurance as a sector in the limelight and could have convinced more players from the private sector to [access] the public markets, but the returns have been disappointing and the street seems to be a bit cautious on the sector," says Prakarsh Gagdani, CEO of 5Paisa, a discount broking company. The LIC stock touched its all-time high of ₹920 on the day of its debut on May 17 but is now at around ₹639 (on November 18).

Meanwhile, Bajaj Finance and Kotak Mahindra Bank have been pushed out of the top 10 ranks this year to No. 11 and No. 12, respectively, despite registering growth in average market cap of 26.8 per cent and 4.1 per cent, respectively, during the study period.

THE SECTORAL LENS

In terms of sectors, the collective category of BFSI—banking, financial services & insurance—continues to rule the rankings with over 80 representations, led by segment heavyweights like HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, LIC, Bajaj Finance, Axis Bank, HDFC Life Insurance Company and SBI Life Insurance Company, among others.

Jimeet Modi, Founder & Group CEO of SAMCO, a group with presence in broking and the mutual fund business, has a strong outlook for the BFSI segment as he believes that the lending industry is poised to grow exponentially on the back of huge demand, especially from retail borrowers. "BFSI as a sector offers great compounding benefits as it has the ability to redeploy



"The biggest signal that one got after some of the big guns of the start-up segment listed on the bourses was that you have to value capital since it is limited in nature. You cannot splurge it in the interest of growth"

Prakarsh Gagdani
CEO, 5Paisa



"There is a long way to go for the Indian markets to attain depth... Till we attain that, volatile movements will happen with new names coming in or going out of the list"

Jimeet Modi
FOUNDER & GROUP CEO,
SAMCO

capital efficiently and generate returns. India is a great lending story and, hence, BFSI will continue to offer good opportunity, although our preference is towards retail lenders, especially private banks and NBFCs," he says. Incidentally, India's only listed stock exchange, the BSE, which is Asia's oldest bourse, saw its rank jump from No. 497 to No. 351 as its valuation more than doubled to ₹9,138 crore from the earlier ₹3,460 crore.

Moving away from sectors on to conglomerates, the Gautam Adaniled Adani Group has been in the limelight this year as the stock prices of most of its listed entities have registered strong growth. Barring Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone, which saw its rank drop slightly from 29 to 31, all the other Adani entities have seen their ranks improve, with Adani Power registering the biggest jump from 136 to 58. Adani Green Energy (15), Adani Transmission (19), Adani Total Gas (22) and Adani Enterprises (24) all improved their ranks as the average market cap of most of the group's entities more than doubled when compared to the previous study. Newly-listed Adani Wilmar, India's biggest FMCG company, made its debut on the bourses in February this year, and made its entry in the BT500 rankings at No. 62.

STARTING UP IN THE RANKINGS

More than 30 new names—that were not listed or eligible to be ranked earlier—have entered the BT500 rankings this year, with start-ups hogging the limelight even as most have been in the news for their lacklustre performance in the public markets and their losses. Investment banker-turned-entrepreneur Falguni Nayar—who also fea-